

WLAN, this PDA is truly for the wireless at heart.

ASUS' P535 is very responsive and has decent signal quality too. Some loss in voice clarity in zone 1, but that was acceptable.

The Jasjar didn't drop any calls, but quality was low, especially in zone 1; do not opt for this phone if cellular reception is an issue in your area, and if that is an important factor affecting your decision. That aside, music playback is very good—a 3.5 mm jack is always appreciated. Wi-Fi performance was surprisingly good considering the older 802.11b protocol in use.

Both the HTC C800 and O2's Xda Zinc performed better than the Jasjar as signal strength and quality go.

Our Conclusion

For an unbeatable mix of features, like a stellar screen (two screens actually), a great keypad (both keypads in fact), good signal quality, and unbeatable connectivity options, the **E90** is special. Add to the party loads of applications bundled, a great camera, and quality accessories... It sums up to a Digit Best Buy Gold award—Nokia's E90 is highly recommended to corporate users who need the features and don't mind the size.

It's hard to recommend the Imate Jasjar to anyone looking for a PDA phone, despite its features and performance. For one, the model is on the verge of being phased out. It does have the most easy-to-work-with screen of the bunch.

Our Best Buy Silver winner, the **ASUS P535**, is a combination of great and usable features, superb build, functionality, and a good bundle. How we long for a QWERTY keypad on this one! GPS means it's the PDA for road warriors who don't want to invest in an add-on GPS unit.

The **Blackberry 8800** makes for a sensible purchase if you're looking for one-touch connectivity to mail and popular chat services; remember that service providers have special schemes for SIM cards bundled with this phone.

MULTIMEDIA PHONES

The difference between a multimedia phone and a business phone is more about the way manufacturers position devices than anything. For example, Nokia has always had a business series of phones. They now choose the prefix "E" to denote "enterprise," we presume, to denote this category. Their multimedia series now has the prefix "N" (Njoy? Ntertainment? You choose.) Similarly, Sony Ericsson has a "P" series for business class phones, and a "K" series for camera phones. Their Walkman series of phones have model numbers prefixed with "W".

The one thing to remember is that 99 per

cent of all phones are built to a price. While thinking *business phone*, a manufacturer would think office productivity, long e-mails (read QWERTY), and Wireless LAN, among others. Similarly, multimedia phones are used for entertainment, and the tools for entertainment are good PMP features and quality, funky looks, a good camera, and such. With looks ranging from sexy to cute to bizarre, there's literally something for everyone.

After sorting through this month's lot of phones, we selected 19 of them for a comparison shootout that spanned three categories.

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Features

The tiniest phone in this category has the soul of an MP3 player—the **BenQ-Siemens' EF51** has a flap that holds all PMP buttons (playback, next / previous track, pause, etc). Open the flap and the keypad appears. A tiny screen with blurry icons isn't really fun, though.

Samsung had a trio of phones in this category. The **SGH-E840** is by far the best looking of the lot. With an ultra-slick slider, this phone has touch-type menu buttons. The keypad is a little recessed, but feedback isn't a problem. The other two Samsung phones were the slimmest phones we received.

LG's KE820 is an unusual-looking phone. A wide phone with a large keypad that much resembles the keys on a calculator, this is nonetheless really comfortable to type SMSes on. The screen is a let-down: blurry. On to the **Motorola KRZR K1**: Motorola really has their ergonomics right, and while attending a call, the KRZR K1 feels natural in the hand, and the positioning of the speaker and mouthpiece is such that they coincide with your ear and mouth respectively. Some of us liked the keypad, some didn't (too much colour), but it's well-laid-out overall, and feedback is good.

Nothing extraordinary about the **Nokia 6300** as looks go. A slim phone, slightly long, with a solid steel back, the 6300 is built to last. A good screen, great on-screen icons (typical Nokia), only Samsung's E840 gives it a bit of a run for its money as far as the display goes.

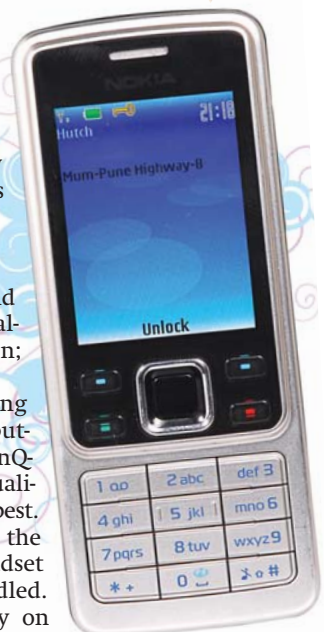
Performance

Nokia's 6300 dominated both the call and audio quality tests. In zone 1 the signal quality was pretty good, very little distortion; zone 2 had no issues whatsoever.

Despite having dedicated PMP buttons, the tiny BenQ-Siemens' audio quality is mediocre at best. The real culprit is the lower-quality headset that comes bundled. The audio quality on the Samsung phones is also mediocre; once again, poor-quality

The ASUS P535, is a combination of great and usable features, superb build, functionality, and a good package

BEST BUY
digit
AUGUST 2007



Nokia 6300
Sleek and functional

Decision Maker		
You Want	Your Budget	We Recommend
Something solid, functional and simple	8,000 to 13,000	Motorola KRZR K1, Nokia 6300, SGH E-840
Funky looks on a budget	8000 to 12000	Samsung SGH E-490, SGH E-840, LG KE820
Great Camera with functionality	Dependent on performance	Nokia N95, Sony Ericsson K790i, Nokia N73ME
Good MP3 player, great screen, with functionality	Up to 25,000	Nokia N73ME, Sony Ericsson K790i
PDA-like features on a budget	Up to 15,000	Nokia E62, HP iPAQ 514
Functional QWERTY/High end PDA functions	Unlimited	Nokia E90, Imate Jasjar, O2 Xda Zinc
PDA with flaunt value	NA	ASUS P535, Sony Ericsson P990i
Upwardly Mobile	What is that?	Nokia 8800 Sirocco
Cheapest way to a touchscreen	14,000	Motomring (A1200)